6.20 Liver Cirrhosis*

Assessment	Nursing Diagnosis	Plan / Expected Outcome	Nursing Interventions	Evaluation
Subjective • "My abdomen and legs are swollen." **Objective** • Ascites • Edema of both legs • Albumin 25 g/L	**ACTUAL** Excessive fluid volume related to portal hypertension and hypoalbuminemia as evidenced by ascites and edema.	• Weight and abdominal girth falling within 1 week.	• Weigh daily and measure abdominal girth. • Restrict sodium as prescribed. • Give diuretics as prescribed; follow potassium and sodium. • Elevate the legs.	• Met as weight and girth decrease.
Subjective • "The itching does not let me sleep." **Objective** • Jaundice • Scratch marks	**ACTUAL** Impaired physical comfort related to pruritus from retained bile salts as evidenced by itching and excoriations.	• Less itching.	• Keep nails short and skin moisturized. • Bathe in cool water, not hot. • Give the prescribed antipruritic.	• Achieved as itching lessens.
Subjective *No specific complaint* **Objective** • Prolonged INR • Low platelets • Varices	**RISK** Risk for excessive bleeding as evidenced by risk factors: coagulopathy and portal hypertension.	• No bleeding.	• Follow INR, platelets and hemoglobin. • Use a soft toothbrush and an electric razor. • Avoid IM injections. • Teach the signs of GI bleeding.	• Outcome reached if no bleeding occurs.

*References for this care plan: [32], [35], [37], [75]. Full entries are listed in the References section of the CPMN book.